

● ONCOLOGY · CONTROLLED CLINICAL TRIAL

The Siteman controlled clinical trial: an orbit, *measured against usual care*

Pancreatic cancer surgery patients and their families at Siteman Cancer Center, Washington University School of Medicine, were issued a CareOrbit and otherwise treated identically to a matched control group. This report presents the study basics: topline results, design, and the full set of measures.

TOPLINE RESULTS · VS. MATCHED CONTROL GROUP

-41%

READMISSIONS

Reduction in readmissions vs. the control group.

-53%

CALLS PRE-OP

Fewer calls to the physician office before surgery; 39% fewer post-op.

+65%

UNDERSTANDING

Improvement in understanding of disease, treatment, and care plans.

+22%

SATISFACTION

HCAHPS and SF-36 patient scores. Family satisfaction rose 38%.

STUDY DESIGN

How the study was run

WHO WAS STUDIED

Approximately 125 users: 50 patients plus roughly 75 family members, all issued orbits. Patients were diagnosed with pancreatic ductal adenocarcinoma (PDAC) and consented to surgery — Whipple or RAMPS — as part of their treatment plan.

HOW RESULTS WERE MEASURED

A matched control group received identical care without CareOrbit. Validated surveys, conducted as personal interviews, measured navigation, understanding, and preparedness; call volume, readmissions, activation, and usage were tracked directly.

WHO RAN IT

Dr. Ryan C. Fields, chief of the Section of Surgical Oncology at Washington University School of Medicine, treating patients at Siteman Cancer Center, St. Louis. A nationally noted cancer surgeon running an NIH-funded translational research laboratory.

Family members were issued orbits alongside patients, and were measured as rigorously. In several categories the family effect was the larger one.

UNDERSTANDING

Understanding of treatment plan and side effects

+65% patients
+42% family members

Measured improvement in understanding of the disease, treatment specifics, and pre- and post-treatment plans, via validated surveys conducted as personal interviews.

NAVIGATION

Ability to navigate the care journey

87% of patients improved
77% of families improved

Improvement in navigating the surgical process: working with the care team, appointments, required actions, and follow-ups.

PREPAREDNESS

Preparedness and accountability

-53% calls pre-op
-39% calls post-op

Fewer calls to the physician office in both periods, indicating patients and families arrived and recovered more prepared.

READMISSIONS

Readmission rate

-41% vs. control group

Reduction in readmissions among CareOrbit patients compared with the matched control group.

SATISFACTION

Satisfaction scores

+22% patients, HCAHPS & SF-36
+38% family members

Improvement in patient HCAHPS and SF-36 satisfaction scores, with an even larger lift among family members.

SUPPORT SERVICES

Utilization of resources and support services

96% of patients and families

Reported reaching additional support and educational resources, internal and external to Siteman, from their orbits.

ADOPTION

Adoption and usage

90% activated their orbit
107 avg. page views per user

90% activated their orbit, in under 4 days on average from invitation. Each user generated an average of 107 page views in the initial usage period.

This report reflects the extent of what can be publicly shared prior to publication of the study; some details of the validated survey instruments remain confidential until that time. Dr. Fields is available for discussion with interested professional parties. Siteman Cancer Center is currently expanding its use of orbits.